

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	02 October 2026
Team ID	6ab7f10630f9767f87728ca3
Project Name	Import Data Using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Brainstorming provides a free and open environment that encourages everyone within a team to participate in the creative thinking process that leads to problem solving. Prioritizing volume over value, out-of-the-box ideas are welcome and built upon, and all participants are encouraged to collaborate, helping each other develop a rich amount of creative solutions.

Reference: <https://www.mural.co/templates/brainstorm-and-idea-prioritization>

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

Role	Name
Team Leader	E Dilli Kumar
Team Member	R Vinish
Team Member	K Jerina
Team Member	B Mohanavalli
Team Member	P Sri Ragavan

Problem Statement

Organizations often maintain large volumes of records (users, incidents, assets, locations, etc.) in spreadsheets such as Excel or CSV files. Entering this data manually into the ServiceNow platform is slow, repetitive and error-prone, and spreadsheet column names rarely match the target table field names. There is a need for a reliable way to import spreadsheet data into ServiceNow tables and map each source column to the correct target field using **Transform Maps**, while ensuring data accuracy, avoiding duplicates and saving time.

Collaboration Approach

- Team met online to discuss the problem and agree on the scope of the project.
- Each member shared ideas independently on digital sticky notes (volume over value).
- Ideas were grouped by theme, discussed and then voted on for prioritization.
- Final problem statement and solution direction were selected by consensus.

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

Each team member contributed ideas related to importing spreadsheet data using Transform Maps. Ideas are listed per member and then grouped into themes.

Individual Brainstorming

E Dilli Kumar (Team Leader)	• Create a custom Import Set table from an Excel file • Define a Transform Map from the Import Set table to the target table • Set coalesce on a unique field to prevent duplicates
R Vinish	• Use Data Source (Excel/CSV) with correct sheet number and header row • Auto-map matching fields, manually map the rest • Preview the first rows of imported data before loading
K Jerina	• Field mapping using Choice Action (create / ignore) for reference fields • Field and Run Script transforms to clean and format data • Convert date and time formats during transformation
B Mohanavalli	• Validate spreadsheet data (blank cells, wrong formats) before import • Review Import Set Rows and Transform History for errors • Create test cases with sample data in a sub-production instance
P Sri Ragavan	• Schedule recurring imports using Scheduled Import • Send notification on import success or failure • Document the import steps as a user guide

Idea Grouping

Group	Ideas Grouped
A. Data Source & Import Set	Excel/CSV data source, custom Import Set table, sheet and header row selection, data preview
B. Transform Map & Field Mapping	Create Transform Map, auto-map and manual mapping, Choice Action for reference fields, coalesce to avoid duplicates
C. Data Cleaning & Validation	Pre-import spreadsheet validation, Run Script / field transforms, date format conversion
D. Testing & Error Handling	Test with sample data, Import Set Rows and Transform History review, error logs
E. Automation & Documentation	Scheduled Import, success/failure notifications, user guide documentation

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

Ideas were scored by the team on **Impact** (value to the project) and **Feasibility** (ease of implementation) on a scale of 1 (low) to 5 (high). Ideas with the highest combined score are treated as top priority.

Idea	Group	Impact	Feasibility	Total	Priority
Create Data Source and Import Set from Excel file	A	5	5	10	High
Create Transform Map and map source fields to target fields	B	5	5	10	High
Coalesce on unique field to avoid duplicate records	B	5	4	9	High
Choice Action for reference / choice fields	B	4	4	8	Medium
Validate spreadsheet data before import	C	4	5	9	High
Run Script / field transforms for data cleaning	C	4	3	7	Medium
Review Import Set Rows and Transform History for errors	D	4	5	9	High
Test with sample data in sub-production instance	D	4	4	8	Medium
Scheduled Import for recurring uploads	E	3	3	6	Low
Success / failure notifications	E	3	3	6	Low
User guide documentation	E	3	5	8	Medium

Selected Solution (Top Priority)

- Upload the spreadsheet through a Data Source and load it into an Import Set table.
- Create a Transform Map to map spreadsheet columns to the target table fields.
- Use coalesce on a unique field so existing records are updated and duplicates are avoided.
- Validate data before import and review Import Set Rows / Transform History after the transform to confirm successful loading.

Conclusion

Using Transform Maps to import spreadsheet data into ServiceNow saves time, reduces manual data entry errors and keeps data consistent. The prioritized ideas form the base for the next phase: requirement analysis and project design.